

ROM CRC, CPU clock measurement, FPU probe, RTC/NVRAM, an 18.2 Hz tick, and a complete INT 14h serial driver.

The operating-system-facing half does not exist yet. There is no bootstrap — `_main_()` ends by calling `testmain()` and then powers the CPU down. INT 19h, INT 10h, INT 16h, and INT 17h all fall through `stub.asm` into a shared "invalid function" return that sets carry and `AH=01`. INT 13h exists as scaffolding but has never been executed successfully — it contains at least five independent bugs, any one of which is fatal, and the POST never populates the drive tables it depends on.

Nothing here is architecturally wrong; it is unfinished, in a predictable order. About 52K of the 64K ROM window is still free, which is more than enough room for everything below.

ROM IMAGE TODAY

WRITABLE DATA SEGMENT

INT VECTORS THAT WORK

BLOCKING DEFECTS

12,896 B

of 65,536 — 80% free

0 B

_DATA + _BSS are empty

4

11h, 12h, 14h, 1Ah (+ IRQ0)

11

across 13h_disk, diskide, main

01

What already works

Read against the source, POST is substantially complete and the low-level drivers are real code, not placeholders.

Board initialisation — `start.asm`

- Expanded I/O unlock (the `REMAPCFG` state machine), flags-register sanity test, then table-driven word and byte port init.
- Chip selects: UCS = 64K ROM at `F0000` (8-bit, 5 ws); CS0 = ECB I/O at `0400-04FF` ; CS1 = IDE at `01F0` (8-bit, 3 ws); CS2 = DRAM `00000-FFFFFF` (16-bit, 2 ws); CS3 = external memory at `B0000` ; CS4 = SRAM, *disabled* at `HALF_MEM=0` . Refresh unit and watchdog bus monitor both enabled.
- Memory: walking-ones dword march over `0000:0000-9000:FFFF` , plus SRAM sizing. Extended memory is sized by dropping into 32-bit protected mode (`sizer.asm`) and returning to real mode — that machinery is working and will be reusable for INT 15h AH=87h.
- ROM CRC16 verified against the value planted at `0xFFEE` by `bin2hex` .
- CPU clock measured with the Timer 0 / Timer 1 gate trick, then PSCLK reprogrammed to exactly 1 MHz and the refresh counter recalculated for the measured clock. Nicely done.
- FPU probed via `FNINIT` / `FNSTSW` / `FNSTCW` ; `equip_flag` bit 1 set accordingly.

Drivers and services

- **INT 14h** (`14h_sio0.asm`) — complete and correct: init, write, read, status, PS/2 extended init, divisor table to 460,800 baud. This is the console the whole BIOS currently speaks through.
- **INT 1Ah** (`1Ah_time.asm`) — functions 00–05 plus a DS1302-specific 20h–24h group (burst NVRAM read/write, write-protect, trickle-charge control). Timer 0 drives INT 08h at 18.2066 Hz, chaining INT 1Ch and servicing the BDA tick count, FDC motor timeout and the printer/serial countdown bytes.
- **INT 11h / INT 12h** — real, reading `equip_flag` and `memory_size` from the BDA.
- **ICU** — master and slave 8259s initialised AT-compatibly (vectors 08–0F and 70–77), with `mask_interrupt` / `unmask_interrupt` helpers.
- **IDE** (`diskide.asm`) — 8-bit PIO read, write, IDENTIFY and init. It enables ATA SET FEATURES 01h (8-bit transfers), which the board requires because CS1 is wired 8-bit.
- **C runtime** — `printf` over INT 14h, `getchar` / `getline` , and `option_get` (a numbered-choice prompt). These are assembled into `set_top()` , a genuinely interactive SETUP menu reached by pressing a key during the POST scroll, backed by a CRC-protected 31-byte NVRAM image. Two of its four entries — Fixed Disks and Floppy Disks — are `printf("...not implemented")` stubs.

THERE IS NO COMMAND MONITOR

`testmain()` is a straight-line test *script*, not a monitor: what it runs is fixed at compile time by the `#define` block at the top of `testmain.c` , and it returns when it reaches the end. There is no prompt and no command dispatch anywhere in the ROM. The pieces one would be built from all exist and work — the console, the line editor, the menu loop — so Phase 0 below assembles them into one, and hangs it off the `set_fixed()` stub that is already in the SETUP tree.

02

The interrupt map

This is the clearest picture of where the BIOS stands. Note the block of entries that share one fall-through in `stub.asm` : they do not `IRET` quietly — they return `CF=1, AH=01` , which is what DOS will see when it tries to print a character or read a key.

VECTOR	SERVICE	STATE	NOTES
00–07	CPU exceptions	STUB	All alias to a single <code>IRET</code> .
08	IRQ0 — timer tick	WORKING	18.2066 Hz, chains INT 1Ch, maintains BDA counters.
09–0F	IRQ1–7	EOI ONLY	Non-specific EOI then <code>IRET</code> . Fine until you use them.
10	Video	RETURNS ERROR	Falls into the invalid-command return. Every DOS console write fails.
11	Equipment list	WORKING	Video and floppy bits are never set, though.
12	Conventional memory	WORKING	Reports 640K.
13	Disk	NON-FUNCTIONAL	Only 41h/42h are written, and both fail. See section 03.
14	Serial	COMPLETE	The strongest module in the tree.
15	Misc / system	PARTIAL	Only AH=86h (delays ≥ 250 ms) and a 4Fh stub. 87h/88h/C0h/C1h missing.
16	Keyboard	RETURNS ERROR	COMMAND.COM cannot read input at all.

17	Printer	RETURNS ERROR	Should report "not present" cleanly instead.
18	ROM BASIC / boot failure	RETURNS ERROR	Should land in the monitor.
19	Bootstrap loader	MISSING	Nothing in the image ever attempts a boot.
1A	Time / RTC	WORKING	Plus the DS1302 extension group.
1B / 1C	Break / user tick	IRET	Correct as-is.
1D / 1E / 1F	Parameter tables	NOT TABLES	Vectors point at code, not at the tables DOS may read.
40	Floppy	INVALID CMD	Correct — there is no FDC on the board.
41 / 46	Fixed disk parameter tables	NOT TABLES	Both point at an IRET instruction. INT 13h dereferences them as T_DISKTAB .
70-77	IRQ8-15	EOI ONLY	Cascade EOI handled correctly.

Source: page0vectors in start.asm, cross-referenced against stub.asm fall-through order.

03

Defects found by inspection

These are code-reading findings, not observed failures — confirm each on hardware as you go. Taken together they say the same thing: **the INT 13h path has never successfully executed.** That is consistent with the symptom you describe.

01

```
main.c — if (code) bda.disk_tab[0] = FX_IDEm;
```

Drives are registered only when code is non-zero — that is, only when the NVRAM

BLOCKER

checksum is *bad*, the clock is stopped, or charging is disabled. On a healthy board no disk is ever registered. The condition is inverted.

02 POST — `bda.hd_number` is never written

Nothing in the image assigns it, so it stays 0. `get_disk_table` compares the drive number against it and rejects every call, including 41h and 42h. There is no disk enumeration step at all.

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03 `13h_disk.asm` — `get_disk_table` , `mov di,[di+dtab_vectors]`

`dtab_vectors` is a table of *bytes* (`db 0x41,0x46,...`) but is read as a word. Index 0 yields `0x4641` instead of `0x41` , so the subsequent `shl di,2 / les di,[di]` loads a garbage far pointer. Needs a byte load, zero-extended.

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04 `13h_disk.asm` — `fn41_check_extensions_present`

After `get_disk_table` returns the table in `ES:DI` , the flags test uses `[bx+disk_flags]` . `BX` at that point is still the caller's `0x55AA` magic number. Should be `[di+disk_flags]` .

BLOCKER

05 `13h_disk.asm` — `fn42_read_sector` , `mov bx,1`

`read_tab` is { `microSD=0`, `DualSD=0`, `IDE_READ_SECTOR` } . With `bx=1` , `add bx,bx` gives byte offset 2 — word index 1 — which is the *null* DualSD entry. The call target must be derived from `disk_tab[]` , not hard-coded; for IDE it needs to select index 2.

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06 `13h_disk.asm` — `floppy_call` , `ret 2`

Inside an interrupt handler this is a *near* return: it pops IP, discards CS, and leaves the caller's flags on the stack. Must be `retf 2` . Latent today because there is no floppy, but it will bite the moment something calls INT 13h with `DL<0x80` — which DOS does while probing.

BUG

07 `13h_disk.asm` — CHS entry points

Functions 00, 02, 03, 04, 08, 15 and packet calls 43, 44, 47, 48 are all aliased to

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`ret_invalid_command` . AH=02h (CHS read) is what a DOS boot sector and IO.SYS actually use; without it nothing loads.

08 `diskide.asm` — IDE_READ_SECTOR / IDE_WRITE_SECTOR

DRQ is polled once *before* the sector loop. ATA raises DRQ per sector during multi-sector PIO, so any transfer of more than one sector will run ahead of the drive and desynchronise. DOS reads multiple sectors constantly. The DRQ wait belongs inside the loop.

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09 `diskide.asm` — error handling

The ERR bit and the error register are never read, so every failure collapses to `AX=-1` . INT 13h cannot produce meaningful status codes, and DOS's retry logic keys off them.

BUG

10 `diskide.asm` — timeouts

`ide_wait_not_busy` and `ide_wait_drq` spin on `CX=0FFFFh` with `loopnz` . That is both clock-dependent (16–33 MHz) and far too short for drive spin-up or a reset. Use the 1 MHz Timer 1 that POST already sets up.

BUG

11 `main.c` — end of `_main_()`

`testmain(); printf("\nShutdown.\n"); return 8;` — control returns to `exit_` in `start.asm`, which enters PWRCON power-down and halts. There is no `int 19h` anywhere in the ROM.

BLOCKER

04

Constraints that shape the work

Four properties of this build will dictate how you write every new module. Two of them are easy to violate accidentally.

THE ONE THAT WILL CATCH YOU OUT

There is no writable data segment. The makefile puts `_TEXT` , `CONST` , `CONST2` , `_DATA` and `_BSS` all in `DGROUP` , which lives entirely in ROM — `start.map` shows `_DATA` and `_BSS` at zero length. Any C global or `static` you add lands in ROM. `const` data is fine and belongs there — `testmain.c` already uses `static const` tables — but anything you intend to *write* will silently discard the write. All mutable state must live in the BDA at `0040:xxxx` or on the stack. Add the field to `bda.h` and let `copt` regenerate `bda.inc` .

- **64K ROM window, ~52K free.** The UCS covers `F0000–FFFFF` only, and the current image is 12,896 bytes. Everything below fits comfortably; you are not space-constrained.
- **The console is SIO0, and only SIO0.** There is no video controller and no PS/2 keyboard on the board. `INT 10h` and `INT 16h` must be a terminal emulation layered on the serial port — that is the single largest piece of new code in this plan, and the one most likely to need iteration.
- **IDE is wired 8-bit.** `CS1` is configured with the bus-size bit clear, which is why `IDE_INITIALIZE` issues `SET FEATURES 01h` . Only drives that honour the 8-bit transfer feature will work. CompactFlash cards do; most spinning IDE drives do not. Plan on CF.
- **The POST stack sits at A800:0000** . Because `CS4` is disabled at `HALF_MEM=0` , that address is actually served by DRAM through `CS2`. It is above the 640K the BIOS reports, so it will not collide with DOS — worth keeping that way deliberately rather than by accident.
- **BIOS code executes from 8-bit ROM at 5 wait states.** Every `INT 13h` and `INT 10h` call pays for that. If disk or console throughput disappoints later, `SHADOW_MODE` is the lever.

The plan

Ordered by dependency, not by size. Phase 0 builds the instrument the rest of the plan is tested with; disk comes next, because with that instrument in hand you can prove out storage over the serial console you already have, before taking on the much fuzzier console emulation. Effort figures assume you already know this codebase.

PHASE 0 Ground truth and a monitor

~1 day

Before changing anything, make the build reproducible and build the instrument you will diagnose everything else with. You are about to do a lot of surgery on code that has never run, and right now the ROM has no way to ask the hardware a question interactively.

git Put the tree under version control. There is no repository here today, and the next four phases touch nearly every file.

build Fix the `rom128/256/512.hex` targets — they currently emit empty files (`:00000001FF`); only `rom064.hex` is real. Generate `date.inc` from the build rather than hand-editing it.

new **Build the command monitor.** A `while` loop over `getline()` and a small command table is all that is missing — `printf`, `getchar`, `getline` and `option_get` already work. Hang it on the `set_fixed()` entry in `set_top()`, which is a stub today and is exactly where disk commands belong.

commands Start with four: IDENTIFY dump, LBA sector dump in hex, BDA dump, and an I/O port peek/poke. These are the instrument for all of Phase 1 and the first six rungs of the bring-up ladder.

watch out No writable statics — see section 04. A command table must be `const`; any line buffer or parsed argument has to be a local on the stack.

log Capture a serial log of the current POST as a baseline to diff against.

PHASE 1 Make INT 13h real

2–3 days

The deepest work in the plan. Target: `AH=02h` CHS reads and `AH=08h` geometry queries that a DOS boot sector will accept, backed by an IDE driver that survives multi-sector transfers.

new file **Disk enumeration at POST.** Add a `hdinit` module: soft-reset the interface, issue IDENTIFY to master and slave, and parse words 1/3/6 (default geometry), 49 (capabilities) and 60–61 (LBA sector count).

tables Build a `T_DISKTAB` per drive and point the **INT 41h and INT 46h vectors** at them — they currently point at an `IRET`. Set `bda.hd_number` and `bda.disk_tab[]` here, unconditionally, and delete the inverted assignment in `main.c`.

geometry Choose an LBA-assist translation (16/32/64/128/255 heads × 63 sectors) so the reported cylinder count stays ≤ 1024 . Store both the physical and translated geometry; `AH=08h` returns the translated one.

port **Port the CHS entry points from `SBC386/HardDisk/DIDE.ASM`** — the SBC-188 driver already implements `fn00`, `02`, `03`, `04`, `08`, `15` and a working `cv_1ba` CHS→LBA conversion against the same BDA layout. This is the single biggest shortcut available to you.

fix Repair defects `03–07`: byte-load `dtab_vectors`, use `DI` in `fn41`, derive the driver index from `disk_tab[]` in `fn42`, and change `floppy_call` to `retf 2`.

driver In `diskide.asm`: move the DRQ wait inside the sector loop, read the error register on failure and map it to BIOS status codes, and replace the `loopnz` timeouts with 1 MHz Timer 1 deadlines.

status Record the last operation's result in `bda.hd_status` and implement `fn01` (get status) — DOS reads it after failures.

PHASE 2 Bootstrap and hand-off

~1 day

Small, and it makes the machine feel like a PC for the first time. Prove it with a hand-written boot sector that prints through INT 14h — that isolates the boot path from the console work in Phase 3.

new file **INT 19h.** Model it on `ATBIOS/test6.asm` : `BOOT_STRAP_1` , which you already have: clear `0000:7C00` , retry loop, read drive 80h cylinder 0 / head 0 / sector 1 via `AH=02h` , verify the `0AA55h` signature at offset 510, set `DL=80h` , then `jmp 0000:7C00` with `DS=ES=0` and a sane `SS:SP`.

POST Replace the tail of `_main()` : after the summary, issue `int 19h` instead of `testmain()` . Keep the self-test reachable from a keypress or a SETUP menu entry so you do not lose it.

INT 18h On boot failure, print a real message and drop into the Phase 0 monitor rather than halting or returning an error code. This is what makes a failed boot debuggable instead of silent.

setup Implement `set_fixed()` — currently it prints "not implemented". A boot-device byte in NVRAM plus the drive table it already has room for.

PHASE 3 Console — INT 10h, 16h, 17h

3–5 days, and the most likely to overrun

A serial terminal pretending to be a PC display and keyboard. Scope this to what `IO.SYS` and `COMMAND.COM` actually call; resist building a full VGA BIOS.

INT 10h Minimum viable set: `0Eh` teletype, `0Fh` get mode, `03h` get cursor, `02h` set cursor, `06h/07h` scroll, `09h/0Ah` write char (+attr), `00h` set mode, `08h` read char/attr, `01h` cursor shape (accept and ignore), `05h` set page. Emit ANSI/VT100 sequences for positioning and scrolling; maintain `vid mode` . `vid columns` and `vid cursorfl` in the BDA as you go.

decision

Keep a real 80×25×2 text buffer at `B800:0000` (DRAM already covers it) and mirror writes to the serial line. It costs 4K of DRAM you are not using, makes `08h / 09h / 0Ah` honest, and gives programs that write video memory directly somewhere valid to land.

INT 16h

Functions 00/01/02 and 10h/11h/12h, fed from a ring buffer in the BDA — `buffer_head`, `buffer_tail` and `kbd_buffer[16]` are already defined. Translate inbound VT100 escapes (arrows, Home/End, function keys) into PC scan codes, map DEL/BS sensibly, and synthesise a scan code for each ASCII character from a table.

important

Make serial receive interrupt-driven. INT 14h is polled; if INT 16h only polls, every keystroke typed while DOS is producing output is lost. Enable the SIO0 receive interrupt and fill the BDA ring buffer from the handler. Decide this now — retrofitting it later means rewriting INT 16h.

INT 17h

Return a clean "not present / timeout" status so DOS's LPT probe terminates instead of reading the invalid-command return.

plumbing

Point `VIDEO_putchar` in `stub.asm` at INT 10h so POST messages and DOS output share one path. Set the video bits (4:5) and floppy bits in `equip_flag`.

PHASE 4 INT 15h and the parameter tables

~1 day

The remaining calls DOS and its standard drivers make. None are needed for a bare boot; all are needed before the system feels finished.

AH=88h

Return `bda.extended_memory`. HIMEM.SYS will not load without it.

AH=87h

Extended-memory block move. `sizer.asm` already contains working protected-mode entry and exit — lift that machinery rather than writing it again.

AH=86h

Handle delays under 250 ms; the current code rejects them. Use the 1 MHz Timer 1.

AH=C0h

Return a system configuration table (model FCh, submodel, BIOS revision, feature bytes).

cheap, and several utilities query it.

tables

Point INT 1Eh at a real disk base table. Verify the INT 41h/46h tables from Phase 1 are what DOS expects to find.

PHASE 5 Hardening

as needed

After DOS boots. None of this blocks the milestone.

reset

Ctrl-Alt-Del path: warm-boot flag 1234h at 40:72 and a clean re-entry to INT 19h.

speed

Shadow the ROM into DRAM (SHADOW_MODE) — the BIOS currently executes from 8-bit ROM at 5 wait states, which every disk and console call pays for.

watchdog

Confirm the bus-monitor watchdog does not trip during long DOS I/O. It is enabled today (WATCH_BUS 1).

slave

Second IDE device, and the SD-card driver slots already reserved in read_tab / write_tab .

06

Bring-up ladder

Each rung is independently observable on the serial console, and each one only depends on the rungs below it. Do not skip ahead — a failure at rung 9 with rungs 1–8 unverified is very hard to diagnose.

01 IDENTIFY dump

Words

1/3/6
and
60–
61
from
the
monitor.
Proves
the
CF
card,
the
8-bit
feature
negotiation,
and
CS1
timing.

02 Raw LBA 0 dump

512
bytes
in
hex,
ending
in
55
AA .
Proves
the
PIO
read

path.

03 Multi-sector read

Read
8
sectors
in
one
command
and
compare
against
8
single-
sector
reads.
This
is
the
test
that
catches
defect
08.

04 INT 13h AH=08h

Geometry
from
the
monitor.

Proves

Proves

enumeration,

the

disk

tables,

and

the

INT

41h

vector.

05 INT 13h AH=02h

CHS

read

of

cylinder

0 /

head

0 /

sector

1,

byte-

identical

to

rung

2.

Proves

the

CHS→LBA

conversion.

06 Write and read back

A
scratch
sector
well
away
from
anything
you
care
about.

07 Custom boot sector, INT 14h output

A
hand-
written
512-
byte
sector
that
prints
"HELLO"
through
the
serial
driver.
Proves
INT
19h
with
the
console

still
out
of
the
picture.

08 Custom boot sector, INT 10h output

Same
sector,
printing
via
AH=0Eh .
Proves
the
video
emulation's
most-
used
entry
point.
Then
a
variant
that
echoes
INT
16h
input.

09 DOS boot sector

A

real
VBR
that
loads
IO.SYS.
Expect
to
iterate
on
INT
10h
coverage
here.

10 Full boot to the prompt

COMMAND.COM
will
exercise
far
more
of
INT
10h
and
INT
16h
than
anything
before
it.

Media and DOS version

Prepare a CompactFlash card on a PC: one primary FAT16 partition, **504 MB or smaller**, geometry 16 heads × 63 sectors. That keeps the whole boot chain inside plain CHS addressing with no 1024-cylinder translation, which removes an entire class of problem from the first bring-up. You can relax it later once the LBA packet calls are trusted.

Start with **MS-DOS 6.22**. Its BIOS demands are the most predictable and best documented, and the AT BIOS listing you already have in `SBC386/ATBIOS` is the exact reference for what it expects. Keep FreeDOS as a second target — it is more tolerant and more talkative about what it finds, which makes it a useful diagnostic when 6.22 fails silently.

07

Risks worth naming now

- **Serial input loss** is the most likely source of mysterious behaviour once DOS runs. Polled receive plus a busy CPU equals dropped keystrokes. Handle it in Phase 3, not later.
- **The ROM CRC check halts the machine.** POST verifies CRC16 against the value `bin2hex` plants at `0xFFEE` and executes `HLT` on mismatch. Any hand-patched image will brick silently — always go back through the makefile.
- **CS2 and UCS overlap at F0000** . Intel warns against overlapping chip selects and the README records real trouble here. It appears resolved, but a DOS program writing into segment F000 will land in DRAM, not ROM.
- **8-bit IDE limits your drive choice.** If a drive does not accept `SET FEATURES 01h` , no amount of BIOS work will make it read. Confirm at rung 1.

- **The 64K ROM window is a hard ceiling.** You have ample room today, but INT 10h with a text buffer, INT 16h with scan-code translation, and full INT 13h will together add real bulk. Watch `start.map` as you go.

Where the leverage is

Two pieces of code already in this tree do most of the heavy lifting if you reuse rather than rewrite: `SBC386/HardDisk/DIDE.ASM` is a complete, working INT 13h for the SBC-188 against the same BDA layout, and `SBC386/ATBIOS/ATBIOS/` is the IBM AT BIOS listing — the definitive answer to "what exactly does DOS expect here" for the bootstrap, the disk calls and the parameter tables. Between them, Phases 1 and 2 are largely a porting exercise. Phase 3 is the part that is genuinely new work.

08

Source tree inventory

Every source file in `SBC386/bios` , and whether the build actually touches it. Membership was determined from the makefile's `OBJECTS` list cross-checked against the module list in `start.map` , so "linked" means the object is genuinely in the ROM image, not merely that a rule exists for it.

40 of the 93 source files never reach the ROM. Thirty-eight are not compiled at all; two more are compiled into `sbc386.lib` but the linker never pulls them in. Almost all of it is either SBC-188 heritage, prototype-era experiments, or the author's own numbered backup snapshots.

SOURCE FILES	LINKED INTO THE ROM	INCLUDES & BUILD INPUTS	NOT IN THE BUILD
93	22	27	40

86 in root, 7 in lib/	19 asm/C + 3 from lib	7 of them generated	safe to remove after Phase 0
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A • ASSEMBLY MODULES IN THE ROM

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT DOES
start.asm	LINKED	POST. Chip-select and port init tables, IVT population, memory march test, ROM CRC, CPU clock measurement, FPU probe, LED codes, then calls <code>_main()</code> .
boot.asm	LINKED	The 16-byte reset block at <code>FFFF:0</code> — <code>jmp F000:0000</code> plus the date stamp. Both <code>%include d</code> by <code>start.asm</code> and assembled standalone to <code>boot.tmp</code> for <code>exe2rom</code> .
sizer.asm	LINKED	GDT prototype and the protected-mode entry/exit used to size extended memory in 1 MB steps. Reuse this for INT 15h AH=87h.
crc.asm	LINKED	CRC16 over <code>ES:BX</code> ; built as <code>crc16.o</code> with <code>-dCRC16=1</code> . Used for the ROM self-check and the NVRAM checksum.
diskide.asm	LINKED	8-bit PIO IDE driver: read, write, IDENTIFY, and the SET FEATURES 01h init. Defects 08–10 live here.
13h_disk.asm	LINKED	INT 13h dispatcher, driver tables and packet validation. Defects 03–07 live here.
14h_sio0.asm	LINKED	INT 14h serial driver plus <code>install_SIO0()</code> and the baud divisor table.
15h_misc.asm	LINKED	INT 15h dispatcher. Only AH=86h is written, and only for delays over 250 ms.
1Ah_time.asm	LINKED	INT 1Ah, the IRQ0 tick handler, and the entire DS1302 RTC/NVRAM bit-banger. The largest module in the tree.
11h_12h.asm	LINKED	INT 11h equipment word and INT 12h conventional memory size. Both trivial, both correct.
icu.asm	LINKED	<code>mask_interrupt</code> / <code>unmask_interrupt</code> for the 8259 pair, callable from C.
crxpc.asm	LINKED	Returns a far pointer to the <code>crxpc</code> word in the BDA — the C library's only writable global

<code>etlno.asm</code>	LINKED	returns a far pointer to the <code>etlno</code> word in the BDA — the C library's only writable global.
<code>stub.asm</code>	LINKED	Placeholder handlers for every unimplemented vector. This is the file you delete from as Phases 2–4 land.

B • C MODULES IN THE ROM

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>main.c</code>	LINKED	<code>_main()</code> — installs the serial console, prints the banner and machine summary, enters SETUP when needed, then calls <code>testmain()</code> . Defects 01 and 11 live here.
<code>set1302.c</code>	LINKED	The SETUP menu: <code>set_top</code> , <code>option_get</code> , and the clock, date, charger and serial editors. <code>set_fixed()</code> and <code>set_floppy()</code> are stubs.
<code>testmain.c</code>	LINKED	The compile-time-selected test script — CPRINTF, day-of-week, tick display, and probes for 4UART / VGA3 / CVDU ECB boards.
<code>getline.c</code>	LINKED	Line editor over the serial console. One of the pieces the Phase 0 monitor is built from.
<code>signon.c</code>	LINKED	<code>pr_lic()</code> copyright and GPL banner, plus <code>get_time</code> / <code>get_date</code> wrappers over INT 1Ah.
<code>strtobcd.c</code>	LINKED	BCD string parser used by the SETUP date and time editors.

C • LIB/SBC386.LIB

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>lib/cprintf.c</code>	LINKED	<code>printf</code> / <code>cprintf</code> . Output goes out through <code>VIDEO_putchar</code> in <code>stub.asm</code> , which today calls INT 14h directly.
<code>lib/strlen.c</code>	LINKED	Pulled in by <code>cprintf</code> 's <code>%s</code> handling.
<code>lib/uart_det.asm</code>	LINKED	UART type detection. Reaches the ROM only because <code>test_4uart()</code> in <code>testmain.c</code> calls it.

lib/atoi.c	UNLINKED	In the library, but nothing references it.
lib/testide.c	UNLINKED	IDE exerciser. In the library, but <code>T_IDE</code> is 0 in testmain.c so it is never called. Worth reading before you write the Phase 0 monitor's disk commands.
lib/libc.c	UNUSED	Commented out of the library makefile's <code>OBJECTS</code> .
lib/makefile	BUILD	Builds <code>SBC386.lib</code> . Note it is <i>not</i> invoked by the top-level makefile — the library is stale unless you build it by hand.

D • INCLUDES, HEADERS AND GENERATED FILES

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT DOES
seg_def.inc	INCLUDED	Segment and DGROUP definitions. This file is the origin of the no-writable-data constraint in section 04.
i386ex.inc	INCLUDED	386EX peripheral register addresses and bit names, for assembly.
i386ex.h	INCLUDED	The same register set for C. Used by main.c.
macro.inc	INCLUDED	<code>binit</code> / <code>winit</code> init-table macros, <code>pushm</code> / <code>popm</code> , <code>get_bda</code> , and the GDT descriptor builders.
timer.inc	INCLUDED	Timer and PSCLK constants, the MS18 / MS50 divisors, and the baud rate base.
serial.inc	INCLUDED	Serial constants; included only by 14h_sio0.asm.
CRC16TAB.INC	INCLUDED	CRC16 lookup table for crc.asm.
date.inc	INCLUDED	The 8-character build date stamped into the reset block. Hand-edited — currently reads <code>09/26/26</code> . Phase 0 automates it.
lib/printf.c	UNUSED	The BIOS Date Argument and the <code>printf</code> module that translates C strings into

SBC-386EX BIOS Bring-Up		
bda.n + bda.rul	BUILD INPUT	The BIOS Data Area layout, and the <code>copt</code> rules that translate a C struct into NASM equates. <code>bda.rul</code> drives all four generated <code>.inc</code> files.
bda.inc	GENERATED	From <code>bda.h</code> . Included by eleven modules — the shared vocabulary of the whole BIOS.
disktab.h → disktab.inc	GENERATED	Fixed-disk parameter table and the INT 13h packet structures. Central to Phase 1.
error.h → error.inc	GENERATED	BIOS status/error codes.
stack.h → stack.inc	GENERATED	<code>offset_ax</code> , <code>offset_flags</code> and friends — for reaching into a saved register frame from inside an interrupt handler.
nvr.am.h	INCLUDED	NVRAM layout and the device-code enum (<code>FX_IDEm</code> , <code>FX_uSD</code> ...). Also pulls in <code>bda.h</code> and <code>serial.h</code> .
disk.h	INCLUDED	Disk driver signatures and the device-number enum. Included by <code>set1302.c</code> .
mytypes.h, cprintf.h, getline.h, ascii.h, serial.h, strtobcd.h	INCLUDED	Small C headers — base types, the <code>printf</code> and line-editor prototypes, ASCII names, serial config struct, BCD parser prototype.

E • NOT IN THE BUILD – THE DUST

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT IS, AND WHETHER TO KEEP IT
alloc.asm	UNUSED	EBDA / UMB allocator. <code>main.c</code> declares <code>ebda_alloc()</code> but never calls it. Keep — Phase 4 may want it.
baseio.asm	BROKEN	Dual-SD-card board I/O. It <code>%include s</code> <code>sdcard.inc</code> , which does not exist anywhere in the tree, so it cannot assemble even if you added it to the makefile.
microsd.c	UNUSED	On-board micro-SD driver skeleton. The matching slots in

`read_tab / write_tab` in `13n_disk.asm` are null pointers.

<code>ds1302.asm</code>	SUPERSEDED	Earlier standalone RTC driver. The live version lives inside <code>1Ah_time.asm</code> .
<code>dsreg.asm</code>	SUPERSEDED	DS1302 register definitions in <i>MASM</i> syntax (<code>TITLE</code> , <code>PAGE</code> , <code>.xlist</code>) — wrong assembler for this build entirely.
<code>muldiv.asm</code>	UNUSED	Its entire body is wrapped in <code>%if 0</code> .
<code>notice.asm</code>	UNUSED	A boilerplate copyright block meant for inclusion everywhere. Nothing includes it.
<code>equates.asm</code>	UNUSED	SBC-188 equates.
<code>sbc188.h</code> , <code>libc.h</code>	UNUSED	SBC-188 leftovers. Both are still listed in the makefile's <code>CINCL</code> variable but included by nothing.
<code>pm_sio.asm</code> , <code>pm_test.asm</code> , <code>rm_test.asm</code>	UNUSED	Prototype-era protected-mode serial and memory-test experiments. <code>sizer.asm</code> is the survivor of this line of work.
<code>startup.asm</code>	SUPERSEDED	The old monolithic TEST1 ROM. The makefile still carries a rule for it, explicitly labelled "obsolete".
<code>seg.c</code> , <code>seg_at.asm</code> , <code>make.seg</code>	UNUSED	A self-contained three-file experiment proving <code>SEGMENT AT 40h</code> addressing of the BDA. Its conclusion is already baked into <code>bda.inc</code> .
<code>zero.asm</code> , <code>zero.inc</code> , <code>zero.h</code> , <code>zero.rul</code>	UNUSED	A BDA-zeroing helper, fully wired into the makefile — <code>zero.inc</code> is even listed in <code>INCLUDES</code> — but <code>%include</code> d by nothing. The corresponding zeroing code in <code>start.asm</code> is inside a <code>%if 0</code> .
<code>disk.inc</code>	UNUSED	A copt-generated copy of <code>disk.h</code> that no module includes.
<code>remover.h</code>	UNUSED	Three <code>#define</code> tricks that let one file serve as both a <code>.inc</code> and a <code>.h</code> . Nothing uses it, but it documents the technique — keep the comment if you delete the file.

test.c, tcrc.c, testide.c (root)	UNUSED	Scratch and host-side test programs. The root testide.c is a duplicate of lib/testide.c ; check which is newer before deleting either.
start.lkk	UNUSED	An old wlink response file. The makefile line that used it (WLINK @start.lkk) is commented out.
makefile.188, makefile.abs	UNUSED	The SBC-188 makefile and an absolute-address build variant.
1Ah_time.as0, diskide.as0, start.as1, startup.as0, uart_det.as0/.as1/.as2, main.c7	BACKUPS	The author's own numbered snapshots of files that still exist in current form. main.c7 is a Microsoft C7 variant of main.c. Delete these only after Phase 0 puts the tree under git — they are the sole record of some earlier revisions.

F • DOCUMENTATION

FILE	STATE	WHAT IT IS
0UPDATE.TXT	READ THIS	Mandatory board wiring updates, including the DCTL16-7 GAL change and the FPU-detect jumper. Check it before flashing anything.
0README.TXT	KEEP	Dated build history back to 2017 — the overlapping chip-select saga and the MF/PIC console fallback are both documented here.
0USAGE.TXT	KEEP	The BDA fields regrouped by subsystem rather than by address. Derived from bda.h; genuinely useful reference for Phases 1–3.
COPYING	KEEP	GPLv3.

Two makefile cleanups worth doing at the same time

The bottom of the makefile carries a "Leftovers from SBC188" dependency block naming eleven files that do not exist in this tree — sio.c , nvram.c , debug.c , kbd.c ,